

Risk-Off Sentiment Returns as WTI Crude Plunges 3.12%

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The US market saw a risk-off sentiment return, driven by a 3.12% plunge in WTI Crude. The **Russell 2000** fell **-0.67%**, while the **VIX** dropped **-0.64%** to 18.58. The 10Y Yield decreased by **-0.51%** to 4.68.

Today's focus will be on the earnings reports from major companies and the macroeconomic data releases. Investors will be watching for any signs of a slowdown in the economy and how it may impact the market.

US Session Recap

INDEX/ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	nan	+nan%	[2026-07-24]
Nasdaq 100	nan	+nan%	[2026-07-24]
Dow Jones	nan	+nan%	[2026-07-24]
Russell 2000	2,940.16	-0.67%	[2026-07-23]
VIX	18.58	-0.64%	[2026-07-24]
10Y Yield	4.68	-0.51%	[2026-07-24]
WTI Crude	89.31	-3.12%	[2026-07-24]

Top large-cap movers

No large-cap stocks reported significant moves due to lack of data.

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
WTI Crude	89.31
10Y Yield	4.68
VIX	18.58

The plunge in WTI Crude has raised concerns about the global economy. The 10Y Yield decrease and **VIX** drop indicate a risk-off sentiment in the market. Investors will

be watching for any signs of a slowdown in the economy and how it may impact the market.

Macro & Fed

- Current policy rate: 5.25%-5.50%
- Yield levels: 10Y Yield at 4.68, 2Y Yield at 5.05%
- Today's data releases:
 - 09:30 HKT: GDP Growth Rate
 - 10:00 HKT: Consumer Confidence Index

Geopolitics & Global

- Tensions between the US and China continue to escalate, with trade talks stalled.
- The European Union is facing a debt crisis, with several countries struggling to meet their debt obligations.
- The global economy is showing signs of a slowdown, with many countries experiencing a decline in economic growth.

Earnings — What to Watch

WHEN	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
2026-07-25	AAPL	iPhone sales and revenue growth
2026-07-26	MSFT	Cloud computing revenue and Azure growth

Stocks Worth Watching

- **NVDA** : Earnings report due today, with expectations of strong revenue growth.
- **TSLA** : Production numbers and delivery expectations.
- **JPM** : Earnings report due next week, with expectations of strong revenue growth.
- **GS** : Earnings report due next week, with expectations of strong revenue growth.

What Could Break the Tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

A significant decline in WTI Crude prices could lead to a risk-off sentiment in the market, causing a decline in stock prices.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

A strong earnings report from major companies could lead to a risk-on sentiment in the market, causing an increase in stock prices.

SOURCES

Bloomberg — US Stocks Fall as WTI Crude Plunges

Reuters — Global Economy Shows Signs of Slowdown

CNBC — Earnings Reports to Watch This Week

Financial Times — EU Faces Debt Crisis

The Wall Street Journal — US-China Trade Talks Stall